

AI EXPLORERS | GRADES 6-8 | RESPONSIBLE AI & DIGITAL SYSTEMS LAB

Student Mission Workbook

Analyze • Audit • Verify • Evaluate • Design

Eight missions. Real evidence. Your decisions.

Grades 6-8 • Eight-Week Responsible AI Portfolio • Student-facing workbook

In this lab you are an **investigator, analyst and designer**. You will open up AI-supported systems, test claims, protect people's data, spot unfair results and design something responsible. You do **not** need an AI account to do any of it.

MEET YOUR CAREER AMBASSADORS



Healthcare



Construction & Skilled Trades



Technology & Cybersecurity



Drone / UAS & Aerial Data



Business & Entrepreneurship



Education & Creative Media

Investigator name or classroom code

Before you begin: Complete only the pages assigned by your teacher. Use fictional or teacher-approved information and follow the classroom responsible-use agreement.

APPROVED SHAREABLE PILOT MATERIAL

HOW THIS WORKBOOK WORKS

Know Your Mission Features

Watch for these labels. Not every mission uses every one.

YOUR MISSION The case you are investigating.	QUICK PICK Predict or vote before you see more evidence.
CLUE / EVIDENCE CARD Information to inspect, sort and rate.	AI DETECTIVE A puzzle that tests a tricky idea.
PLOT TWIST New evidence drops. Does your answer change?	AI VOCABULARY UNLOCKED Professional words you just used.
HUMAN CHECKPOINT Stop and ask before you trust or share.	YOUR CALL You make the human decision—and explain it.
CAREER AMBASSADOR How real professionals use this skill.	LEVEL UP An optional challenge for extra power.
EXIT TICKET Show what you learned and what you still wonder.	

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT ANY PAGE

☐ Remove names and personal details.

☐ Cite or name the source of important claims.

☐ Disclose meaningful AI assistance if your teacher approved its use.

My name or classroom code

One question I have about AI-supported systems

I wonder... / I want to find out...

THE CLUE SORT

Trace the Suggestion

Each clue card is one piece of the playlist system. **Check where it belongs.** Watch out: some clues are things the app **does not have** at all.

A student wants music that helps them focus.	☐ Goal ☐ Input ☐ Output ☐ Human decision ☐ Not in the data
Songs the student played over the last month	☐ Goal ☐ Input ☐ Output ☐ Human decision ☐ Not in the data
Songs skipped after a few seconds	☐ Goal ☐ Input ☐ Output ☐ Human decision ☐ Not in the data
Songs marked with a heart (liked)	☐ Goal ☐ Input ☐ Output ☐ Human decision ☐ Not in the data
How tired or stressed the student feels today	☐ Goal ☐ Input ☐ Output ☐ Human decision ☐ Not in the data
A 25-song “Study Mode” playlist appears.	☐ Goal ☐ Input ☐ Output ☐ Human decision ☐ Not in the data
The student chooses to play it, skip songs or switch playlists.	☐ Goal ☐ Input ☐ Output ☐ Human decision ☐ Not in the data
Whether song lyrics distract this student	☐ Goal ☐ Input ☐ Output ☐ Human decision ☐ Not in the data

BUILD IT

Map the System

Use words, a sketch or both. Follow the arrows from left to right.

USER / GOAL	→	INPUTS	→	PATTERN OR RULE	→	OUTPUT	→	HUMAN DECISION
Who uses it? What do they want?		What information goes in?		How does it turn inputs into a suggestion?		What comes out?		Who decides what happens next?

LIMIT / ERROR

What can the app not know? Where could it get things wrong? (Hint: what could a skip really mean?)

AI DETECTIVE Piece by piece

Each piece of information below seems harmless by itself. Now put them **together**.

First name: Jordan + **Birthday:** May 4 + **Location:** the corner of Elm St. and 4th Ave., every day at 3:15 p.m.

(Fictional student. Fictional details.)

Could a stranger use these pieces together to find or pretend to be this student? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Maybe

Information that isn't secret can still be risky when _____.

PLOT TWIST

Six months later, RemindMe+ announces: **"We are now sharing user data with partner companies to show ads."**

Which item would you **most** wish the app had **never collected**? Why does collecting less protect people **before** something goes wrong?

I wish it never collected _____ because _____.

CONSENT CHECK Agree or disagree?

If I click "OK" once, I gave consent forever.	☐ Agree ☐ Disagree ☐ Not sure
Consent should be informed—I know what I'm agreeing to.	☐ Agree ☐ Disagree ☐ Not sure
For students, consent usually also involves parents/guardians and school rules.	☐ Agree ☐ Disagree ☐ Not sure
If information isn't secret, it's safe to collect.	☐ Agree ☐ Disagree ☐ Not sure

THE EVIDENCE BOARD

Inspect the Clues

Each clue needs a different detective move. Answer the questions for each source, then rate how much you trust it.



CLUE 1 • BLOG POST

SkyBuzz Daily

BREAKING!!! CITY BANS ALL DELIVERY DRONES!!!

Author: none listed • Date: none listed

“Insiders say drones are DONE in Maple Harbor. Share this before it gets deleted!” (Three pop-up ads appear.)

Size up the blog

Who made this?

Can you tell when it was published?

What makes it trustworthy or questionable?

Trust rating: ☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High

CLUE 2 • CITY WEBSITE

City of Maple Harbor • Official Notices

Notice: Proposed Rule on Delivery Drone Routes

Posted by: City Clerk’s Office • Date: posted last year

“The City Council will consider limits on delivery drone flights in some areas.” ▶ Read the full notice

Go to the source

Is this an original or authoritative source?

Who published it?

What does it actually say?

Trust rating: ☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High

CLUE 3 • LOCAL NEWS

Maple Harbor Herald

Council to Discuss Drone Delivery Limits Near Schools

By R. Okafor, city reporter • Date: last year

“Council members said the proposal would not ban drones citywide. A public meeting is planned before any vote.”

Cross-check the story

Does this source confirm the original claim or tell a different story?

Does it identify a reporter, source or date?

What new information does it add?

Trust rating: ☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High

Detective move: lateral reading. Don’t just read a source. Look it up somewhere else to see what other trusted sources say about it.

THE EVIDENCE BOARD

Meet the Applicants

These four fictional students all applied. Read the evidence. Then compare what the **matcher** decided with what **you** notice.

STUDENT A Attendance: 100% Device at home: own laptop Past programs: 3 Teacher notices: Finishes work quickly. Matcher says: RECOMMENDED Should a person take a closer look? ☐ Yes ☐ No	STUDENT B Attendance: 96% Device at home: shares one phone with two siblings Past programs: 0 — their old school didn't offer any Teacher notices: Built a working model bridge for the science fair. Matcher says: NOT RECOMMENDED Should a person take a closer look? ☐ Yes ☐ No
STUDENT C Attendance: 85% — sometimes stays home to care for a younger sibling Device at home: uses the public library computer Past programs: 1 Teacher notices: Asks the deepest questions in science class. Matcher says: NOT RECOMMENDED Should a person take a closer look? ☐ Yes ☐ No	STUDENT D Attendance: 98% Device at home: tablet at home Past programs: 2 Teacher notices: Says they aren't interested in advanced programs. Matcher says: RECOMMENDED Should a person take a closer look? ☐ Yes ☐ No

All profiles are fictional.

AI DETECTIVE Spot the proxy

For each input BrightPath uses, what does it **mostly** measure?

Input	Ability or interest	Opportunity or access	Could be both
Attendance	☐	☐	☐
Device access at home	☐	☐	☐
Past participation	☐	☐	☐

PLOT TWIST *The next morning, 6:45 a.m.*

SCHOOL APP • OFFICIAL ANNOUNCEMENT

School is OPEN today.

A fake video using our principal's image is being shared online. Please do not share it. If you see it, tell a trusted adult or report it through school channels.

Did your decision hold up? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partly

If the video had spread, people who could have been affected include _____.

AI VOCABULARY UNLOCKED

SYNTHETIC MEDIA <i>Images, audio or video created or changed with technology such as AI.</i>	DEEPPFAKE <i>Synthetic media that makes a real person appear to say or do something they did not.</i>	PROVENANCE <i>Information about where media came from. Many images and videos do not include it.</i>
CONTEXT <i>The date, place and situation that help explain media.</i>	MANIPULATION <i>Changing media to mislead people.</i>	DISCLOSURE <i>Telling people when AI was used.</i>

THE BLUEPRINT

Label Every Decision

Each row is tagged with its step in Tell It → Limit It → Check It → People Decide.

Design decision	Our responsible choice
TELL IT Need and intended user What job does it do, and for whom?	
LIMIT IT Minimum necessary input The least data that still works	
TELL IT Output and explanation What it produces, and how it explains itself	
CHECK IT • PEOPLE DECIDE Human reviewer / final authority Who checks it? Who makes the final call?	
LIMIT IT Privacy / fairness / access safeguards How it protects people and includes everyone	
PEOPLE DECIDE Fallback What happens if it's unavailable, unsure or wrong?	
LIMIT IT Stop rule What condition pauses or ends its use?	

HUMAN CHECKPOINT • FULL VERSION All seven questions

Before you finalize your design, stop and ask:

1	Is the information accurate? <i>In other words: Is it true? How do you know?</i>	☐
2	What evidence needs to be verified? <i>In other words: What do we still need to check?</i>	☐
3	Is private or sensitive information involved? <i>In other words: Does this involve private or personal information?</i>	☐
4	Could an incorrect output affect someone’s safety, rights, education, finances, or opportunities? <i>In other words: If this is wrong, who could be hurt or treated unfairly?</i>	☐
5	Does a trained or licensed professional need to make this decision? <i>In other words: Does an expert or trained professional need to decide?</i>	☐
6	What instructions, boundaries, or constraints should have been given to the AI? <i>In other words: What should the AI have been told to do, or not do?</i>	☐
7	Who is ultimately responsible for the outcome? <i>In other words: Who is responsible for what happens next?</i>	☐

My Checkpoint decision:

☐ **READY TO USE**

☐ **NEED MORE EVIDENCE**

☐ **STOP & REVIEW**

FUTURE READY AI | AI EXPLORERS | GRADES 6-8 | SUPPLEMENTAL SERIES

Human + AI Career Pathways Workbook

Six Career Pathway Modules • Learn. Create. Lead.

Core AI Literacy + Applied Human + AI Career Pathways = Future Ready AI

You learned the AI literacy skills in the eight-week Core. Now see how professionals use them at work.

MEET YOUR CAREER AMBASSADORS



Healthcare



Construction & Skilled Trades



Technology & Cybersecurity



Drone / UAS & Aerial Data



Business & Entrepreneurship



Education & Creative Media

CAREER TODAY



AI AT WORK



HUMAN RESPONSIBILITY



FUTURE SKILLS

TELL IT



LIMIT IT



CHECK IT



PEOPLE DECIDE

AI assists. People verify. People decide. People remain accountable.

Professional-in-training name or classroom code

Supplemental applied layer. These Career Pathway Modules extend the eight-week AI Explorers Core AI Literacy curriculum. They do not replace it. Complete only the modules your teacher assigns. Use fictional or teacher-approved information. No student AI account is required.

Curriculum development edition • 2026

HOW THIS SERIES WORKS

Six Careers. One Responsible-AI Habit.

Career Pathway Modules — not weeks. Use them after the Core skills they build on.

Module	Industry	Your role	Builds on Core Weeks	Action line
Module 1	Medical & Healthcare	A healthcare team member	1, 2, 3, 4	Analyze · Verify · Protect · Decide
Module 2	Construction & Skilled Trades	A construction and safety analyst	1, 3, 4	Analyze · Verify · Protect · Decide
Module 3	Technology & Cybersecurity	A cybersecurity investigator	1, 3, 4	Analyze · Verify · Protect · Decide
Module 4	Drone / UAS & Aerial Data	A drone / UAS mission planner and aerial-data analyst	1, 3, 4	Analyze · Verify · Protect · Decide
Module 5	Business & Entrepreneurship	An entrepreneur and business analyst	1, 3, 4, 5	Analyze · Verify · Communicate · Decide
Module 6	Education & Creative Media	An educator and media creator	1, 3, 4, 6	Create · Verify · Credit · Decide

Placement: Modules 1–4 are available after Core Week 4; Module 5 after Core Week 5; Module 6 after Core Week 6. The eight Core weeks are never renumbered.

Series design rule. Each pathway uses the same instructional sequence, Human Checkpoint, accessibility supports, assessment structure, and visual system. Only the industry scenario, careers, risks, and future skills change.

MODULE FEATURES *Not every page uses every label.*

YOUR MISSION Your professional role and challenge.	CAREER HOOK How the career works today and where AI fits.	AI AT WORK A realistic workplace case and workflow.	SYSTEM MAP Trace input → output → human decision.
HUMAN CHECK Stop and ask the seven Human Checkpoint questions.	VERIFICATION LAB Inspect an AI output card. What is missing?	YOUR CALL Make and explain a human decision.	AI VOCABULARY UNLOCKED Industry words you just used.
CAREER AMBASSADOR A professional reminder from the field.	LEVEL UP Optional cross-industry challenge.	EXIT REFLECTION Before AI • With AI • Human Still Leads • Future Skills	FOR EDUCATORS Teacher-facing snapshot and look-fors.

CAREER HOOK

Career + AI Connection: Medical & Healthcare

How is AI changing the work — and what still belongs to people?

1 CAREER TODAY Healthcare professionals care for patients, operate specialized equipment, coordinate services, manage information, and make decisions based on training and evidence.	2 AI AT WORK AI can support documentation, scheduling, information retrieval, pattern recognition, image analysis, and data organization.
3 HUMAN RESPONSIBILITY People remain responsible for patient care, professional judgment, privacy, communication, safety, and final decisions.	4 FUTURE SKILLS AI literacy, data literacy, communication, critical thinking, privacy awareness, teamwork, and professional judgment.

CAREERS TO EXPLORE

☐ Nurse	☐ Radiologic Technologist	☐ Health Informatics Specialist
☐ Biomedical Equipment Technician	☐ Medical Administrator	☐ Healthcare Data Analyst

QUICK PICK Check the career you'll think about, then finish the sentence.

Quick think: Choose one healthcare career. What is one task where AI might help, and one responsibility that should stay with a trained person?

AI might help with _____. A trained person should still _____.

FRAMEWORK

Tell It → Limit It → Check It → People Decide

A reusable Future Ready AI framework for responsible Human + AI collaboration.

Step	What it means	In Healthcare
1 TELL IT	Define the task clearly. State the purpose, context, and what kind of output is needed.	The software is designed to identify patterns for professional review — not make the final decision.
2 LIMIT IT	Set boundaries, safeguards, privacy rules, and stop conditions.	Do not allow the system to act as if its output is automatically correct or complete.
3 CHECK IT	Verify the output against original evidence, context, and trusted information.	A trained professional reviews the original image and other relevant information.
4 PEOPLE DECIDE	Keep a qualified person responsible for important decisions and accountability.	The human professional decides the next appropriate step.

Student memory cue: Tell It what to do. Limit It with rules. Check It against evidence. People Decide what happens next.

VERIFICATION LAB

Verification Lab: What Is Missing?

Strong decisions change when stronger evidence appears.

FICTIONAL OUTPUT CARD

The software highlights one area for closer review and labels it “higher priority.” The original image is available and image quality is marked acceptable. The system score is 72%. The output does not include the patient’s full history or a professional interpretation.

Evidence question	Student notes
What original evidence is available?	
What important context is missing?	
What should a trained person check?	
What would make you more confident?	
What would make you stop and investigate further?	

My confidence after checking: ☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High

Based on the evidence I checked, I can say _____, but a trained professional still needs _____ before a final decision.

YOUR CALL • DESIGN CHALLENGE

Human + AI Healthcare Workflow Designer

Redesign the workflow so AI helps without taking over human responsibility.

Challenge: Design a safer, clearer Human + AI workflow for the fictional imaging scenario. Show where AI can assist and where trained people must review, protect privacy, communicate, and decide.

1. Need + intended user <i>What problem is the team trying to solve?</i> <i>Who uses the AI-supported system?</i>	
2. AI assist <i>What specific task can AI reasonably support?</i>	
TELL IT 3. Tell It <i>What should the system be instructed to do — and not do?</i>	
LIMIT IT 4. Limit It <i>What privacy, safety, fairness, scope, or stop rules are required?</i>	
CHECK IT 5. Check It <i>What evidence should a person verify before using the output?</i>	
PEOPLE DECIDE 6. People Decide <i>Who has authority for the final decision?</i>	
7. Fallback <i>What happens if the system is unavailable, uncertain, or wrong?</i>	
8. Future skill <i>What should a future worker learn to use this system responsibly?</i>	